complexes that parallel a shore, and are separated from it by lagoon.

This is the largest (in size, not distribution) of the three reefs, runs for hundreds of kilometres and is several kilometres wide. It extends as a broken, irregular ring around the coast or an island, running almost parallel to it.

An atoll is a roughly circular (annular) oceanic reef system surrounding a large (and often deep) central lagoon.

Statement 3: INCORRECT—Atolls are far more common in the Pacific than any other ocean. The Fiji atoll and the Funafuti atoll in the Ellice/Island are well known examples of atolls. A large number of atolls also occur in the Lakshadweep Islands.

15. Statement 1: CORRECT—Coral reefs are absent on west coast of tropical continents due to Cold Ocean Currents - corals like warm waters and hate cold waters.

Statement 2: CORRECT—Natural disturbances which cause damage to coral reefs include violent storms, flooding, high and low temperature extremes, El Nino Southern Oscillation (ENSO) events, sub aerial exposures, predatory outbreaks and epizootics.

Statement 3: CORRECT—Coral bleaching is not irreversible. Coral reefs can be recovered when ideal conditions for the formation of reefs retain or when zooxanthalae returns.

Mass bleaching can turn a coral dominated reef to an algae dominated one in the space of a few months—a process that can take decades or longer to reverse.

16. The Mediterranean Sea, which is divided by a 400 meter sill into two sub basins, is connected to the Atlantic Ocean via the Straits of Gibraltar, to the Black Sea via the Bosporus Strait, and to the Red Sea via the manmade Suez Canal.

The Gulf of Mexico is connected to the Atlantic Ocean via the Straits of Florida and the Caribbean Sea via the Yucatán Strait.

TSUGARU STRAIT—It lies between Hokkaido and Honshu in northern Japan and connects the Sea of Japan to the Pacific Ocean.

17. 1. Agalega Island-Indian Ocean, located N-E of Madagascar.
2. Spratly Island-South China Sea, located west to Philippines.
3. Aleutian Island-Pacific Ocean, connects Asia and America.